



Incident handler's journal

Instructions

As you continue through this course, you may use this template to record your findings after completing an activity or to take notes on what you've learned about a specific tool or concept. You can also use this journal as a way to log the key takeaways about the different cybersecurity tools or concepts you encounter in this course.

Date: October 8, 2025	Entry: #1
Description	Documenting a cybersecurity incident - phishing malicious attachment
Tool(s) used	n/a
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • Who An organized group of unethical hackers • What A ransomware security incident encrypted the companies files • When Tuesday 9:00 am • Where At a healthcare company in the US • Why Unethical hackers were able to access the company's systems using an email phishing attack. The attackers launched their ransomware on the company's systems, encrypting critical files. The attackers' motivation appears to be financial because the ransom note demanded a large sum of money in exchange for the decryption key.
Additional notes	<i>Training the company on malicious attachments could help prevent future occurrences like this. It may also help to set up a new policy to have new attachments investigated before opening them.</i>

Date: November 5th, 2025	Entry: #2
Description	I analyzed an artifact using VirusTotal.
Tool(s) used	VirusTotal
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • An Employee • An employee downloaded a suspicious file that contained malware. • 11/05/2025 • An employee's work computer • An employee wasn't cautious enough
Additional notes	The file was recognized by VirusTotal as malware.

Date: November 6th, 2025	Entry: #3
Description	An employee received an email containing a malicious attachment.
Tool(s) used	VirusTotal
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident.

	• An employee downloaded and opened a malicious file from a phishing email • The email was sent on Wednesday, July 20, 2022 at 09:30:14 AM • On the employee's work computer • Proper procedures weren't followed
Additional notes	The file is reported to be malicious by 56 of 71 vendors on VirusTotal. The incident was escalated.

Date: Record the date of the journal entry.	Entry: Record the journal entry number.
Description	Provide a brief description about the journal entry.
Tool(s) used	List any cybersecurity tools that were used.
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • Who caused the incident? • What happened? • When did the incident occur? • Where did the incident happen? • Why did the incident happen?
Additional notes	Include any additional thoughts, questions, or findings.

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The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • Who caused the incident? • What happened?

	• When did the incident occur? • Where did the incident happen? • Why did the incident happen?
Additional notes	Include any additional thoughts, questions, or findings.

Need another journal entry template?

If you want to add more journal entries, please copy one of the tables above and paste it into the template to use for future entries.

Reflections/Notes: Record additional notes.
